



A PARASHA BOOK · PARASHAT LECH LECHA

Go! Avram's Great Journey

starring Aviya, Tzofia & Lielle

לך-לך

Meet the explorers



Aviya, Tzofia & Lielle are about to climb into Parashat Lech Lecha (Genesis 12:1–17:27). Everything they see on these pages comes straight from the pesukim — the plain meaning, the *peshat*. Each picture page is followed by the words of the Torah it comes from, in Hebrew and English, and a question to look for in the text.



1

Go!

Go!

This time the Chumash opened with just two words, and they rang out like a bell: "Lech lecha — Go!" The sisters found themselves in Charan, beside a big tent. Hashem was speaking to Avram: Go from your land, from your birthplace, and from your father's house, to the land that I will show you. I will make you a great nation and bless you, and you will be a blessing. Tzofia whispered, "But where?" Aviya looked at the page. "He doesn't say yet," she said. "Avram just has to go."

Look closely: What did Hashem promise Avram if he would go?

To make him a great nation, to bless him, make his name great — and that he would be a blessing (12:2).

FROM THE TORAH · BERESHIT 12:1-3

¹ וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה אֶל־אַבְרָם לֵךְ מֵאֶרֶץ וּמִמּוֹלֶדְתְּךָ וּמִבֵּית אָבִיךָ אֶל־הָאָרֶץ
אֲשֶׁר אֹרְאָךְ:

² וְאֶעֱשֶׂךָ לְגוֹי גָּדוֹל וְאֶבְרַכְךָ וְאֶגְדֹּלְהָ שְׁמִי וְהָיָה בְרָכָה:

³ וְאֶבְרַכְהָ מְבֹרָכֶיךָ וּמְקַלְלֶיךָ אָאֵר וְנִבְרָכוּ בְּךָ כָּל מִשְׁפָּחֹת הָאָדָמָה:

^{12:1} Now the Lord said to Avram, Get thee out of thy country, and from thy kindred, and from thy father's house, to the land that I will show thee:

^{12:2} and I will make of thee a great nation, and I will bless thee, and make thy name great; and thou shalt be a blessing:

^{12:3} and I will bless them that bless thee, and curse him that curses thee: and in thee shall all the families of the earth be blessed.



On the Road

Avram went, just as Hashem told him, and Lot went with him. Avram was seventy-five years old when he left Charan. He took Sarai his wife, and Lot, and everything they had, and all the people who were with them — and they set out for the land of Canaan. The sisters walked behind the caravan, holding hands in a row. Lielle toddled along as fast as she could. Tzofia asked, "Are we there yet?" about a hundred times. Finally they came to Shechem.

Look closely: How old was Avram when he left Charan?

Seventy-five years old (12:4).

FROM THE TORAH · BERESHIT 12:4-6

⁴ וַיֵּלֶךְ אַבְרָם כַּאֲשֶׁר דִּבֶּר אֱלֹהֵי יְהוָה וַיֵּלֶךְ אִתּוֹ לוֹט וְאֶבְרָם בֶּן־חַמֶּשׁ שָׁנִים
וּשְׁבַע־עֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה בְּצֵאתוֹ מִחָרָן:

⁵ וַיִּקַּח אַבְרָם אֶת־שָׂרַי אִשְׁתּוֹ וְאֶת־לוֹט בֶּן־אָחִיו וְאֶת־כָּל־רְכוּשָׁם אֲשֶׁר רָכְשׁוּ
וְאֶת־הַנְּפֹשׁ אֲשֶׁר־עָשׂוּ בְּחָרָן וַיֵּצְאוּ לְלֶכֶת אֶרֶצָה כְּנַעַן וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶרֶצָה כְּנַעַן:

⁶ וַיַּעֲבֵר אַבְרָם בְּאַרְצָא עַד מְקוֹם שָׁכֵם עַד אֵלּוֹן מוֹרָה וְהַכְּנַעֲנִי אֵז בְּאַרְצָא:

^{12:4} So Avram departed, as the Lord had spoken to him; and Lot went with him: and Avram was seventy five years old when he departed out of Haran.

^{12:5} And Avram took Saray his wife, and Lot his brother's son, and all their substance that they had gathered, and the souls that they had acquired in Haran; and they went forth to go to the land of Kena'an; and into the land of Kena'an they came.

^{12:6} And Avram passed through the land to the place of Shekhem unto the terebinth of More. And the Kena'ani was then in the land.



3

An Altar and a Tent

An Altar and a Tent

Hashem appeared to Avram and said: "To your offspring I will give this land." So Avram built an altar right there. Then he moved on to the hills east of Beit-El and pitched his tent. Aviya pointed: "Beit-El is over there, in the west — and Ai is over there, in the east." Avram built another altar and called out in the name of Hashem. Tzofia stacked little stones into a tiny altar of her own.

Look closely: Between which two places did Avram pitch his tent?

Beit-El on the west and Ai on the east (12:8).

FROM THE TORAH · BERESHIT 12:7-8

⁷ וַיֵּרָא יְהוָה אֶל-אַבְרָם וַיֹּאמֶר לְזֶרְעֲךָ אֶתְּן אֶת-הָאָרֶץ הַזֹּאת וַיְבָן שָׁם מִזְבֵּחַ
לַיהוָה הַנִּרְאָה אֵלָיו:

⁸ וַיַּעֲתֵק מִשָּׁם הַהִרָה מִקֶּדֶם לְבֵית-אֵל וַיֵּט אֶהְלָה בֵּית-אֵל מִיָּם וְהָעִי מִקֶּדֶם
וַיְבָן-שָׁם מִזְבֵּחַ לַיהוָה וַיִּקְרָא בְּשֵׁם יְהוָה:

^{12:7} And the Lord appeared to Avram, and said, To thy seed will I give this land: and there he built an altar to the Lord, who had appeared to him.

^{12:8} And he removed from there to a mountain on the east of Bet-el, and pitched his tent, having Bet-el on the west, and 'Ay on the east: and there he built an altar to the Lord, and called upon the name of the Lord.



4

Famine — and Back Again

Famine — and Back Again

Then there was a famine in the land — no rain, no food. So Avram went down to Egypt to live there for a while. Tzofia's tummy grumbled just hearing about it. Later, Avram came back up from Egypt to the Negev, with Sarai and Lot. And now he was very rich — in cattle, in silver and in gold! Lielle tried to eat a gold coin. Aviya took it back, gently.

Look closely: What was Avram rich in when he came back from Egypt?

Livestock, silver and gold (13:2).

FROM THE TORAH · BERESHIT 12:10; BERESHIT 13:1-2

¹⁰ וַיְהִי רָעָב בָּאֶרֶץ וַיֵּרֶד אַבְרָם מִצְרָיִם לְגֹר שָׁם כִּי־כָבֵד הָרָעָב בְּאֶרֶץ:

¹ וַיַּעַל אַבְרָם מִמִּצְרָיִם הוּא וְאִשְׁתּוֹ וְכָל־אֲשֶׁר־לּוֹ וְלוֹט עַמּוֹ הַנֶּגֶב:

² וַאֲבָרָם כָּבֵד מְאֹד בַּמִּקְנָה בַּכֶּסֶף וּבַזָּהָב:

^{12:10} And there was famine in the land: and Avram went down to Mizrayim to sojourn there; for the famine was severe in the land.

^{13:1} And Avram went up out of Mizrayim, he, and his wife, and all that he had, and Lot with him, into the Negev.

^{13:2} And Avram was very rich in cattle, in silver, and in gold.



5

No Quarreling

No Quarreling

Lot had lots of sheep and cattle and tents too — so many that the land couldn't hold them all together. Avram's shepherds and Lot's shepherds started to quarrel. Tzofia knew all about quarreling over toys. Then Avram said to Lot: "Please, let there be no quarrel between me and you, or between my shepherds and yours — for we are brothers. The whole land is in front of you. If you go left, I'll go right." Aviya and Tzofia looked at each other and shared their snack.

Look closely: What reason did Avram give for not quarreling?

"For we are brothers" — anashim achim anachnu (13:8).

FROM THE TORAH · BERESHIT 13:5-9

5 וְגַם־לְלוֹט הָיָה צֹאן־וּבָקָר וְאֵהֳלִים:

6 וְלֹא־נִשְׂא אֶתֶם הָאָרֶץ לְשִׁבְתָּ יַחַדּוֹ כִּי־הָיָה רְכוּשָׁם רָב וְלֹא יָכֻלוּ לְשִׁבְתָּ יַחַדּוֹ:

7 וַיְהִי־רִיב בֵּין רְעִי מִקְנֵה־אֲבָרָם וּבֵין רְעִי מִקְנֵה־לוֹט וְהַכְנַעְנִי וְהַפְּרִזִּי אֲזִי יֹשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ:

8 וַיֹּאמֶר אֲבָרָם אֶל־לוֹט אֲלֵינָא תְּהִי מְרִיבָה בֵּינִי וּבֵינֶיךָ וּבֵין רְעִי וּבֵין רְעִיךָ כִּי־אֲנָשִׁים אַחִים אֲנַחְנוּ:

9 הֲלֹא כָּל־הָאָרֶץ לִפְנֶיךָ הַפָּרָד נָא מֵעַלִּי אִם־הִשְׁמָאֵל וְאִימָנָה וְאִם־הִזְמִין וְאִשְׁמָאִלָּה:

13:5 And Lot also, who went with Avram, had flocks, and herds, and tents.

13:6 And the land was not able to bear them, that they might dwell together: for their substance was great, so that they could not dwell together.

13:7 And there was a strife between the herdmen of Avram's cattle and the herdmen of Lot's cattle: and the Kena'ani and the Perizzi dwelt then in the land.

13:8 And Avram said to Lot, Let there be no strife, I pray thee, between me and thee, and between my herdmen and thy herdmen, for we are brethren.

13:9 Is not the whole land before thee? separate thyself, I pray thee, from me: if thou wilt take the left hand, then I will go to the right; or if thou depart to the right hand, then I will go to the left.



6

Lot Chooses

Lot Chooses

Lot lifted up his eyes and saw the whole plain of the Jordan — it was watered everywhere, green like the garden of Hashem. So Lot chose the plain, and traveled east, and pitched his tents all the way to Sedom. Aviya read the next line and frowned: the people of Sedom were very wicked. "It looked so pretty," said Tzofia. "Pretty isn't everything," said Aviya.

Look closely: Why did Lot choose the plain of the Jordan?

Because it was well-watered everywhere, like the garden of Hashem (13:10).

FROM THE TORAH · BERESHIT 13:10-13

¹⁰ וַיִּשָּׂא-לוֹט אֶת-עֵינָיו וַיֵּרָא אֶת-כָּל-כַּפְּרֵי הַיַּרְדֵּן כִּי כָלָה מִשְׁקָהּ לִפְנֵי שַׁחַת
יְהוָה אֶת-סֹדֶם וְאֶת-עַמּוֹרָה כְּגַן-יְהוָה כְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם בְּאֵכָה צֹעַר:

¹¹ וַיִּבְחַר-לוֹ לוֹט אֶת כָּל-כַּפְּרֵי הַיַּרְדֵּן וַיֵּסַע לוֹט מִקֶּדֶם וַיִּפְרְדּוּ אִישׁ מֵעַל אָחִיו:

¹² אַבְרָם יָשָׁב בְּאֶרֶץ-כְּנָעַן וְלוֹט יָשָׁב בְּעָרֵי הַכְּפָר וַיֵּאָהֶל עַד-סֹדֶם:

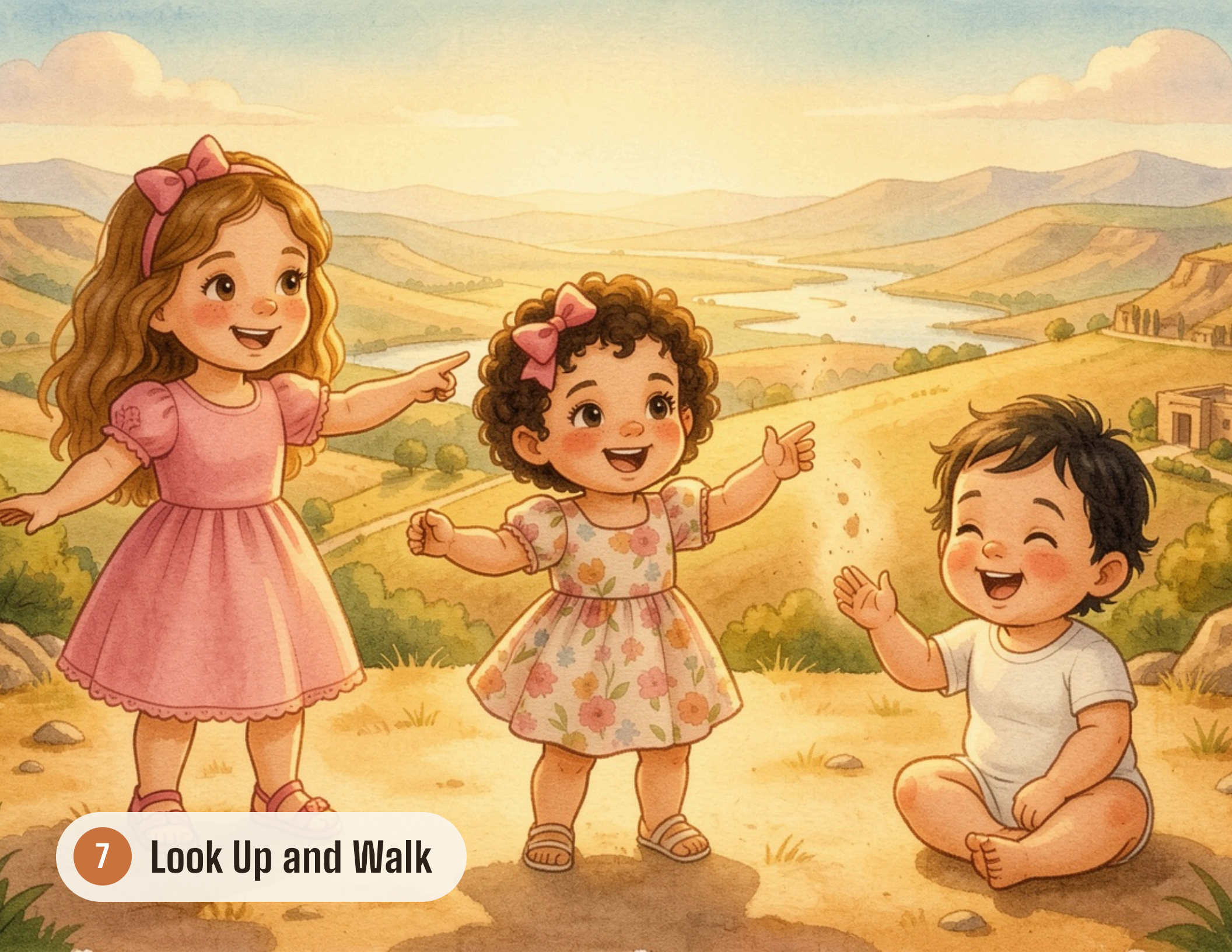
¹³ וְאֲנָשֵׁי סֹדֶם רָעִים וְחַטָּאִים לַיהוָה מְאֹד:

^{13:10} And Lot lifted up his eyes, and beheld all the plain of the Yarden, that it was well watered everywhere, before the Lord destroyed Sedom and 'Amora, like the garden of the Lord, like the land of Mizrayim, as thou comest to Zo'ar.

^{13:11} Then Lot chose him all the plain of the Yarden; and Lot journeyed east; and they separated themselves one from the other.

^{13:12} Avram dwelt in the land of Kena'an, and Lot dwelt in the cities of the plain, and pitched his tent toward Sedom.

^{13:13} But the men of Sedom were wicked and sinners before the Lord exceedingly.



7

Look Up and Walk

Look Up and Walk

After Lot left, Hashem said to Avram: "Lift up your eyes and look — north and south and east and west. All the land you see I will give to you and your offspring forever. I will make your offspring like the dust of the earth. Get up and walk through the land, its length and its width." Tzofia spun in a circle pointing every direction. Aviya picked up a handful of dust and let it blow away. "That many?!"

Look closely: What did Hashem compare Avram's offspring to here?

The dust of the earth — if one could count the dust, his offspring could be counted (13:16).

FROM THE TORAH · BERESHIT 13:14-18

¹⁴ וַיְהִי וְאֵל־אַבְרָם אַחֲרֵי הַפְּרִדָּה לֹט מֵעֵמוּ שָׂא נָא עֵינֶיךָ וּרְאֵה מִן־הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּה שָׁם צִפְנָה וְנִגְבָּה וְקִדְמָה וְיָמָה:

¹⁵ כִּי אֶת־כָּל־הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר־אַתָּה רֹאֶה לְךָ אֶתְנַנָּה וּלְזֶרְעֶךָ עַד־עוֹלָם:

¹⁶ וְשָׁמָּה אֶת־זֶרְעֶךָ כַּעֲפֹר הָאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר אִם־יֹכֵל אִישׁ לִמְנוֹת אֶת־עַפְרַר הָאָרֶץ גַּם־זֶרְעֶךָ יִמְנָה:

¹⁷ קוּם הִתְהַלֵּךְ בָּאָרֶץ בְּאָרְצָהּ וּלְרֹחְבָּהּ כִּי לְךָ אֶתְנַנָּה:

¹⁸ וַיָּאֵהֶל אַבְרָם וַיָּבֹא וַיִּשָּׁב בְּאֵלְנֵי מַמְרֵי אֲשֶׁר בְּחֶבְרוֹן וַיִּבֶן־שָׁם מִזְבֵּחַ לַיהוָה:

^{13:14} And the Lord said to Avram, after Lot was separated from him, Lift up now thy eyes, and look from the place where thou art, northward, and southward, and eastward, and westward;

^{13:15} for all the land which thou seest, to thee will I give it, and to thy seed for ever.

^{13:16} And I will make thy seed as the dust of the earth: so that if a man can number the dust of the earth, then shall thy seed also be numbered.

^{13:17} Arise, walk through the land in the length of it and in the breadth of it; for I will give it to thee.

^{13:18} Then Avram removed his tent, and came and dwelt by the terebinths of Mamre, which is in Hebron, and built there an altar to the Lord.



The Night Rescue

Kings went to war, and Lot was captured and taken away with everything he owned. Someone escaped and ran to tell Avram the Ivri. Avram gathered his trained men — three hundred and eighteen of them, born in his own household — and chased after the captors all the way to Dan. At night he split up his men and rescued Lot. Tzofia hid behind Aviya. But Avram brought everyone back — Lot, his belongings, the women and the people.

Look closely: How many trained men did Avram take with him?

Three hundred and eighteen (14:14).

FROM THE TORAH · BERESHIT 14:12-16

12 וַיִּקְחוּ אֶת־לוֹט וְאֶת־רֶכְשׁוֹ בֶּן־אָחִי אַבְרָם וַיֵּלְכוּ וְהוּא יֹשֵׁב בְּסֹדֹם:

13 וַיָּבֹא הַפְּלִיט וַיַּגֵּד לְאַבְרָם הָעֵבֶרִי וְהוּא שָׂכַן בְּאֵלֶינִי מִמְּרֵא הָאֱמֹרִי אָחִי אֲשָׁכַל וְאָחִי עֲנֹר וְהֵם בְּעָלֵי בְרִית־אַבְרָם:

14 וַיִּשְׁמַע אַבְרָם כִּי נִשְׁבָּה אָחִיו וַיִּרְקַח אֶת־חֲנִיכָיו יְלִידֵי בֵיתוֹ שְׁמֹנֶה עָשָׂר וּשְׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת וַיִּרְדְּף עַד־דָּן:

15 וַיַּחֲלֹק עֲלֵיהֶם לַיְלָה הוּא וְעַבְדָּיו וַיִּכּוּ וַיִּרְדְּפֵם עַד־חֹבָה אֲשֶׁר מִשְׁמָאל לְדַמְשֶׁק:

16 וַיָּשֹׁב אֶת כָּל־הָרֶכֶשׁ וְגַם אֶת־לוֹט אָחִיו וְרֶכְשׁוֹ הַשֵּׁיב וְגַם אֶת־הַנְּשִׁים וְאֶת־הָעָם:

14:12 And they took Lot, Avram's brother's son, who dwelt in Sodom, and his goods, and departed.

14:13 And there came one that had escaped, and told Avram the Hebrew; for he dwelt by the terebinths of Mamre the Emori, brother of Eshkol, and brother of 'Aner: and these were confederate with Avram.

14:14 And when Avram heard that his brother was taken captive, he led forth his trained servants, born in his own house, three hundred and eighteen, and pursued them to Dan.

14:15 And he divided himself against them, he and his servants by night, and smote them, and pursued them to Hova, which is on the left hand of Dammeseq.

14:16 And he brought back all the goods, and also brought back his brother Lot, and his goods, and the women also, and the people.



9

Bread and Wine

Bread and Wine

Malki-Tzedek, king of Shalem, came out to greet Avram with bread and wine. He was a kohen to God Most High, and he blessed Avram. Avram gave him a tenth of everything. Then the king of Sedom said, "Give me the people — keep the riches for yourself." But Avram said no: "Not a thread, not even a sandal strap will I take!" Lielle held up her own sandal. Everyone laughed.

Look closely: What did Avram refuse to take from the king of Sedom?

"Not a thread nor a sandal strap" — nothing at all (14:23).

FROM THE TORAH · BERESHIT 14:18-23

18 וּמַלְכִי־צֶדֶק מֶלֶךְ שָׁלֵם הוֹצִיא לֶחֶם וַיֵּין וְהוּא כֹהֵן לֵאלֹהֵי עֵלְיוֹן:

19 וַיְבָרְכֵהוּ וַיֹּאמֶר בְּרוּךְ אַבְרָם לֵאלֹהֵי עֵלְיוֹן קֹנֵה שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ:

20 וּבְרוּךְ אֱלֹהֵי עֵלְיוֹן אֲשֶׁר־מָגֵן צָרָיו בְּיָדָהּ וַיִּתֵּן־לוֹ מֵעֵשֶׂר מִכָּל:

21 וַיֹּאמֶר מֶלֶךְ־סֹדֶם אֶל־אַבְרָם תֵּן־לִי הַנָּפֶשׁ וְהַרְכָּשׁ קַח־לָךְ:

22 וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְרָם אֶל־מֶלֶךְ סֹדֶם הִרִמְתִּי יָדִי אֶל־יְהוָה אֱלֹהֵי עֵלְיוֹן קֹנֵה שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ:

23 אִם־מְחוּט וְעַד שְׁרוֹךְ־נֶעַל וְאִם־אֶקַּח מִכָּל־אֲשֶׁר־לָךְ וְלֹא תֹאמַר אֲנִי הִעֲשִׂיתִי אֶת־אַבְרָם:

14:18 And Malki-zedeq king of Shalem brought out bread and wine: and he was a priest of the most high God.

14:19 And he blessed him, and said, Blessed be Avram of the most high God, Possessor of heaven and earth:

14:20 and blessed be the most high God, Who has delivered thy enemies into thy hand. And he gave him a tithe of everything.

14:21 And the king of Sedom said to Avram, Give me the persons, and take the goods to thyself.

14:22 And Avram said to the king of Sedom, I have raised my hand to the Lord, the most high God, the Possessor of heaven and earth,

14:23 that I will take nothing from a thread even to a shoe-latchet, and that I will not take anything that is thine, lest thou shouldst say, I have made Avram rich:



Count the Stars

Hashem said to Avram, "Don't be afraid, Avram — I am your shield." Then He took Avram outside and said: "Look at the sky and count the stars, if you can." The sisters lay on their backs and tried. Tzofia got to "eleven!" and gave up. "So will your offspring be," Hashem said. Aviya read the last part twice: Avram believed in Hashem, and Hashem counted it for him as righteousness.

Look closely: What did Hashem tell Avram to count?

The stars — "so shall your offspring be" (15:5).

FROM THE TORAH · BERESHIT 15:1-6

- ¹ אַחֲרֵי הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה הָיָה דְּבַר־יְהוָה אֶל־אַבְרָם בְּמַחְזָה לֵאמֹר אֶל־תִּירָא אַבְרָם אָנֹכִי מִגֵּן לְךָ שְׂכָרְךָ הָרַבָּה מְאֹד:
- ² וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְרָם אֲדֹנָי יְיָהוּה מַה־תִּתֶּן־לִי וְאָנֹכִי הוּלֵךְ עֲרִירִי וּבֶן־מֶשֶׁק בֵּיתִי הוּא דֹמֶשֶׁק אֱלִיעֶזֶר:
- ³ וַיֹּאמֶר אַבְרָם הֵן לִי לֹא נָתַתָּה זָרַע וְהִנֵּה בֶן־בֵּיתִי יוֹרֵשׁ אֹתִי:
- ⁴ וְהִנֵּה דְבַר־יְהוָה אָלָיו לֵאמֹר לֹא יִירָשְׁךָ זֶה כִּי־אִם אֲשֶׁר יֵצֵא מִמְּעֶיךָ הוּא יִירָשְׁךָ:
- ⁵ וַיּוֹצֵא אוֹתוֹ הַחוּצָה וַיֹּאמֶר הִבֵּט־נָא הַשָּׁמַיְמָה וּסְפֹר הַכּוֹכָבִים אִם־תּוּכַל לְסַפֵּר אֹתָם וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ כֹּה יִהְיֶה זֶרְעֶךָ:
- ⁶ וְהֶאֱמַן בַּיהוָה וַיַּחְשְׁבֶהָ לוֹ צְדָקָה:

^{15:1} After these things the word of the Lord came to Avram in a vision, saying, Fear not, Avram: I am thy shield; thy reward will be very great.

^{15:2} And Avram said, Lord God, what wilt thou give me, seeing I go childless, and the steward of my house is Eli'ezer of Dammeseq?

^{15:3} And Avram said, Behold, to me Thou hast given no seed: and, one born in my house is my heir.

^{15:4} And, behold, the word of the Lord came to him, saying, This shall not be thy heir; but he that shall come forth out of thy own bowels shall be thy heir.

^{15:5} And He brought him outside, and said, Look now toward heaven, and count the stars, if thou be able to number them: and He said to him, So shall thy seed be.

^{15:6} And he believed in the Lord; and He counted it to him for righteousness.



The God Who Sees

An angel of Hashem found Hagar by a spring of water in the wilderness, on the road to Shur. "You will have a son," the angel said, "and you will call him Yishmael — because Hashem has heard you." Hagar called Hashem "El Ro'i" — the God who sees me. Tzofia splashed the cool water on her face. "He sees us too?" she asked. Aviya nodded. Avram was eighty-six when Yishmael was born.

Look closely: What does the name Yishmael mean?

"Hashem has heard" your suffering (16:11).

7 וַיִּמְצְאָהּ מַלְאָךְ יְהוָה עַל־עֵין הַמַּיִם בַּמִּדְבָּר עַל־הָעֵין בְּדֶרֶךְ שׁוּר:

8 וַיֹּאמֶר הָגָר שְׁפַחַת שָׂרִי אֵימָזָה בָּאת וְאַנָּה תִּלְכִּי וַתֹּאמֶר מִפְּנֵי שָׂרִי גְבַרְתִּי אֲנֹכִי בְּרַחַת:

9 וַיֹּאמֶר לָהּ מַלְאָךְ יְהוָה שׁוּבִי אֶל־גְּבֻרְתְּךָ וְהִתְעַנִּי תַּחַת יָדֶיהָ:

10 וַיֹּאמֶר לָהּ מַלְאָךְ יְהוָה הֲרֵבָה אֲרֻבָּה אֶת־זֶרְעֶךָ וְלֹא יִסְפָּר מִרְבּוֹ:

11 וַיֹּאמֶר לָהּ מַלְאָךְ יְהוָה הִנֵּךְ הָרָה וּלְדֹתָ בֵּן וְקִרְאָת שְׁמוֹ יִשְׁמָעֵאל כִּי־שָׁמַע יְהוָה אֶל־עֲנִידָךְ:

12 וְהוּא יִהְיֶה פָּרָא אָדָם יָדוֹ בְּכָל יָד כָּל בּוֹ וְעַל־פְּנֵי כָל־אָחִיו יִשְׁכֹּן:

13 וַתִּקְרָא שֵׁם־יְהוָה הַדֹּבֵר אֵלֶיהָ אֲתָה אֵל רָאִי כִּי אָמְרָה הָגַם הָלֵם רְאִיתִי אַחֲרֵי רָאִי:

14 עַל־כֵּן קָרָא לְבָאָר בָּאָר לַחֵי רָאִי הִנֵּה בֵּין־קָדֵשׁ וּבֵין בְּרֹד:

15 וַתֵּלֶד הָגָר לְאַבְרָם בֶּן וַיִּקְרָא אַבְרָם שֵׁם־בְּנוֹ אֲשֶׁר־יָלְדָהּ הָגָר יִשְׁמָעֵאל:

16 וַאֲבָרָם בֶּן־שְׁמֹנִים שָׁנָה וְשֵׁשׁ שָׁנִים בְּלֶדֶת־הָגָר אֶת־יִשְׁמָעֵאל לְאַבְרָם:

16:7 And an angel of the Lord found her by a fountain of water in the wilderness, by the fountain on the way to Shur.

16:8 And he said, Hagar, Saray's maid, whence camest thou? and whither wilt thou go? And she said, I flee from the face of my mistress Saray.

16:9 And the angel of the Lord said to her, Return to thy mistress, and submit thyself to her hands.

16:10 And the angel of the Lord said to her, I will multiply thy seed exceedingly, that it shall not be numbered for multitude.

16:11 And the angel of the Lord said to her, Behold, thou art with child, and shalt bear a son, and shalt call his name Yishma'el; because the Lord has heard thy affliction.

16:12 And he will be a wild man; his hand will be against every man, and every man's hand against him; and he shall dwell in the presence of all his brethren.

16:13 And she called the name of the Lord that spoke to her, Thou God seest me: for she said,

16:14 Have I also here looked after Him that sees me? Therefore the well was called Be'er-laḥay-ro'i; behold, it is between Qadesh and Bered.

16:15 And Hagar bore Avram a son: and Avram called his son's name, whom Hagar bore, Yishma'el.

16:16 And Avram was eighty six years old, when Hagar bore Yishma'el to Avram.



New Names

When Avram was ninety-nine, Hashem appeared to him: "Walk before Me and be wholehearted." Then He gave him a new name: "No longer will you be called Avram — your name is Avraham, because I have made you the father of a multitude of nations." And Sarai became Sarah! "Sarah will have a son," Hashem said, "and you will call him Yitzchak." Tzofia tried out her own name with a new letter. Aviya closed the Chumash, smiling. "Next week," she said, "we meet Yitzchak."

Look closely: Why was Avram's name changed to Avraham?

Because Hashem made him the father of a multitude of nations — av hamon goyim (17:5).

¹ וַיְהִי אֲבֹרָם בֶּן־תִּשְׁעִים שָׁנָה וַתֵּשַׁע שָׁנִים וַיְרָא יְהוָה אֶל־אֲבֹרָם וַיֹּאמֶר
אֵלָיו אֲנִי־אלֹהֵי שָׁדִי הִתְהַלֵּךְ לִפְנֵי וַהֲיֵה תָמִים:

² וְאֶתְנָה בְּרִיתִי בֵינִי וּבֵינְךָ וְאַרְבֶּה אוֹתְךָ בְּמֵאָד מְאֹד:

³ וַיִּפֹּל אֲבֹרָם עַל־פָּנָיו וַיְדַבֵּר אֹתוֹ אֱלֹהִים לֵאמֹר:

⁴ אֲנִי הִנֵּה בְרִיתִי אֵתְךָ וְהָיִיתָ לְאָב הָמוֹן גּוֹיִם:

⁵ וְלֹא־יִקְרָא עוֹד אֶת־שִׁמְךָ אֲבֹרָם וְהָיָה שִׁמְךָ אֲבֹרָהם כִּי אֲבִי־הָמוֹן גּוֹיִם
נִתְּתִיד:

¹⁵ וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים אֶל־אֲבֹרָהם שְׂרִי אִשְׁתְּךָ לֹא־תִקְרָא אֶת־שְׁמָהּ שְׂרִי כִּי
שָׂרָה שְׁמָהּ:

¹⁶ וּבִרְכָתִי אֶתְּהָ וְגַם נָתַתִּי מִמֶּנָּה לְךָ בֶּן וּבִרְכָתֶיהָ וְהָיְתָה לְגוֹיִם מְלִכֵּי
עַמִּים מִמֶּנָּה יִהְיוּ:

¹⁷ וַיִּפֹּל אֲבֹרָהם עַל־פָּנָיו וַיִּצְחַק וַיֹּאמֶר בְּלִבּוֹ הֲלֵבֶן מֵאָה־שָׁנָה יוֹלֵד
וְאִם־שָׂרָה הִבְתִּישְׁעִים שָׁנָה תֵּלֵד:

¹⁸ וַיֹּאמֶר אֲבֹרָהם אֶל־הָאֱלֹהִים לוֹ יִשְׁמַעֵאל יִחְיֶה לְפָנֶיךָ:

¹⁹ וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים אֲבֹל שָׂרָה אִשְׁתְּךָ יִלְדָּת לְךָ בֶּן וְקִרְאתָ אֶת־שְׁמוֹ יִצְחָק
וְהִקְמַתִּי אֶת־בְּרִיתִי אִתּוֹ לְבְרִית עוֹלָם לְזֶרְעוֹ אַחֲרָיו:

^{17:1} And when Avram was ninety nine years old, the Lord appeared to Avram, and said to him, I am the Almighty God; walk before Me, and be perfect.

^{17:2} And I will make My covenant between Me and thee, and will multiply thee exceedingly.

^{17:3} And Avram fell on his face: and God talked with him, saying,

^{17:4} As for Me, behold, My covenant is with thee, and thou shalt be a father of many nations.

^{17:5} Neither shall thy name any more be called Avram, but thy name shall be Avraham; for a father of many nations have I made thee.

^{17:15} And God said to Avraham, As for Saray thy wife, thou shalt not call her name Saray, but Sara shall her name be.

^{17:16} And I will bless her, and give thee a son also of her: and I will bless her, and she shall be a mother of nations; kings of peoples shall issue from her.

^{17:17} Then Avraham fell upon his face, and laughed, and said in his heart, Shall a child be born to him that is a hundred years old? and shall Sara, that is ninety years old, give birth?

^{17:18} And Avraham said to God, O that Yishma'el might live before thee!

^{17:19} And God said, Sara thy wife shall bear thee a son indeed; and thou shalt call his name Yizḥaq: and I will establish My covenant with him for an everlasting covenant, and with his seed after him.

The End

Three sisters follow Avram and Sarai into the land of Canaan. Read it again this Shabbat — and see how much more you can find in the pesukim.

Pesukim from Sefaria (Tanach with Nikkud · The Koren Jerusalem Bible). Illustrations made with FLUX.2 [klein]. Peshat fidelity checked with Jev.